

CAN.dy Dance Project — Venue/Studio Rental Checklist

Use for studios, theaters, bars/clubs, event organizers, and filming locations.

A. Basics to confirm (before you commit)

- **Date(s)/times:** load-in, rehearsal, show, strike; overtime rates
- **Address + access:** parking, entry instructions, ADA access
- **Space specs:** dimensions, floor type, mirrors, sound system, lighting
- **Capacity/occupancy limit** and fire code rules
- **What's included:** chairs, tables, dressing room, storage, water, security

B. Money terms

- **Total fee** and what it covers
- **Deposit amount** + due date
- **Payment method** accepted
- **Refund/cancellation policy** (and deadlines)
- **Reschedule policy** (illness, emergencies, venue issues)
- **Damages/cleaning fees** and what counts as damage

C. Insurance & liability (often the biggest “gotcha”)

- Do they require **general liability insurance**? Amount? (e.g., \$1M)
- Do they require you to name them as **additional insured**?
- Are you agreeing to **indemnify/hold harmless** them? (Try to keep mutual and reasonable.)
- Are there waivers they require participants to sign?

D. Rules & restrictions

- **Shoes/heels rules**, rosin/chalk, floor protection, chair use
- **Noise limits** / curfew
- **Alcohol policy** (if venue)
- **Filming/photography permissions** (important for video projects)
- **Closed rehearsal/privacy** expectations
- **Minors policy** (you're 18+, but venues may still ask)

E. Technical / production (for performances)

- **Sound:** who runs music? input options (aux/Bluetooth/XLR), soundcheck time
- **Lighting:** basic wash vs cues; who operates; extra fees
- **Backstage:** dressing rooms, green room, storage, call time
- **Front-of-house:** ticketing, door staff, ushers, merchandise table
- **Security:** who provides it and when required

F. Key clauses to watch in the contract (ask to edit if needed)

- **Who is the contracting party:** “CAN.dy Dance Project (unincorporated association)” and not an individual, if possible
- **Personal guarantee:** avoid clauses that make an individual personally liable
- **Automatic renewals**
- **One-sided cancellation** (venue can cancel anytime but you can't)
- **Broad indemnity** (you cover everything even if it's their fault)
- **Use of your likeness/content:** ensure you keep rights to your footage
- **Force majeure** language (fires, outages, etc.)—make sure deposits aren't automatically forfeited

G. Internal CAN.dy steps (recommended)

- Get written approval from **both Co-Directors** before signing/committing money (per bylaws).
- Store signed agreements in the shared drive; Secretary keeps the record.
- Add key dates to the project calendar (payment deadlines, cancellation windows).

Tailored add-ons for theaters + studios + bars (plus email templates)

1) Quick “red flags” by venue type

Dance studios

- Cancellation terms that forfeit the entire package if you reschedule.
- Extra charges for **heels/chairs** or restrictions on chair use.
- “No filming” clauses (conflicts with your recording-as-condition rule).
- Studio requiring the account be under an individual’s name (try to contract as “CAN.dy Dance Project, an unincorporated association”).

Theaters

- Hidden labor costs: house manager, technician minimums, load-in/out overtime.
- Ticketing/box office fees, merch splits, alcohol/bar revenue terms.
- Insurance requirements (often 1M–2M) + additional insured.
- Strict marketing/content approvals; restrictions on recording the performance.

Bars/clubs

- Age/ID policy for performers + rehearsal call times (21+ venue even if performers are 18+).
- Revenue split language (door vs bar minimum guarantees).
- Sound levels/curfews; security staffing requirements.
- Strong indemnity/hold harmless clauses; sometimes “you’re responsible for patron behavior” language.

2) Standard negotiation asks (safe to request)

- Add: “CAN.dy Dance Project (unincorporated association)” as renter/producer.
- Add: **mutual** cancellation/force majeure; allow reschedule with credit.
- Limit your indemnity to “to the extent caused by your group” and exclude their negligence.
- Confirm in writing: **filming/photography permitted** (or specify exactly what is allowed).
- Confirm: chair use, heels allowed, floor protection requirements.

3) Email templates

A) Initial inquiry (studio/theater/bar)

Subject: Rental inquiry — CAN.dy Dance Project (date/time)

Hi [Name],

We’re CAN.dy Dance Project, a San Jose–based dance team. We’re interested in booking your space for:

- Date(s)/time(s): []
- Use: [rehearsal / performance / video shoot]
- Estimated participants: []
- Needs: sound playback, chairs (or we bring our own), and permission to film/photograph.

Could you share availability, pricing, deposit/cancellation terms, and any rules regarding heels/chair use and recording?

Thank you,
[Name]
Co-Director, CAN.dy Dance Project
[phone/email]

B) Request contract edits (indemnity/recording/personal guarantee)

Subject: Contract review — requested edits for [date]

Hi [Name],

Thanks for sending the agreement. We can proceed once we confirm a few points:

- 1) Contracting party: please list us as “CAN.dy Dance Project (unincorporated association)” rather than an individual.
- 2) Recording: we request written confirmation that photo/video recording is permitted for our documentation and promotion.
- 3) Indemnity/liability: we request limiting indemnity to claims arising from our group’s acts/omissions and excluding the venue’s negligence.
- 4) Cancellation/reschedule: please confirm [credit/reschedule terms] if we need to move the date.

Happy to hop on a quick call to finalize.

Best,

[Name], Co-Director

C) Theaters: cost clarification (labor/tech)

Subject: Clarifying production costs — [event date]

Hi [Name],

Before we sign, can you confirm the full cost estimate including any required staffing (house manager, sound/lighting techs), minimum call times, load-in/out windows, and overtime rates? A line-item quote would help us budget accurately.

Thank you,

[Name], Co-Director